

Improve Operational Efficiencies with Intelligent Document Processing

With organisations being overwhelmed by unstructured data, intelligent document processing is the need of the hour.



facets of digital information: born-digital, and paper digitised through scanning.

Although digital processes have surpassed paper in efficiency, they still grapple with challenges related to unstructured data arriving in high volumes from multiple sources. Let's take a peek into the journey of document processing through the lens of digital information to understand this better.

Document processing has evolved from manual indexing to OCR (optical character recognition) technologies and, presently, AI/ML and LLM models. However, managing and making the data consumable by downstream systems remains an uphill task, and scalability is an area for continuous improvement.

Intelligent document processing

To address traditional document processing challenges, intelligent document processing (IDP) has taken the driver's seat in recent years. The operational efficiencies achieved so far are encouraging, and IDP is able to handle the format and scale issues well. So, what is IDP, and how does it differ from the traditional OCR technologies?

Transitioning from paper-based to scanned digitised copies poses challenges in searching, which are addressed through metadata tagging (also called indexing). Additionally, OCR enabled technology allows text extraction, simplifying full-text keyword searches. Though OCR

The human race has come a long way over thousands of years of evolution, with the methods employed to pass knowledge and data to future generations evolving from Stone Age writings and paper documents to Xerox machines and the modern-day computers.

There are two interesting dimensions to this data evolution: the physical (paper or analogue) and the digital. Digital data evolution has been ongoing since the 1980s, and today, major businesses have integrated digital elements into their essential functions and processes, creating a hybrid operational model.

However, organisations are still overwhelmed with high volumes of physical and digital documents from multiple sources, often in unstructured

formats. This complexity makes it difficult to manage, govern, and use data with external systems.

While some challenges are traditionally addressed by arranging physical documents with manual indexing and extraction techniques, making data analysis simple and scalable is a continuous exploration.

Besides, the affordability and accessibility of digital media storage, coupled with the internet's growth, make Big Data processing and storage a tough proposition.

Document processing

As information started being stored in document form, 'search and retrieval' emerged as a key challenge for both paper and digital mediums. This challenge intensified due to the two